

Verdant FOODS

For review · Confidential

Decision paper · Traceability

Koltiva partnership: build, partner, or both?

A plain review of Koltiva's offer, what it means for the Verdant Foods platform, the options open to Verdant, and the risks of each.

Prepared for
Verdant Foods management

Prepared by
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Based on
Koltiva Traceability Solutions deck (2025)

THE SHORT ANSWER

Build Verdant's own traceability. Partner with Koltiva only for services that are hard to build.

Verdant does not have to choose between Koltiva and its own platform. Koltiva's own process accepts farm data from other systems, so Verdant can keep its platform as the main record and use Koltiva where it adds something Verdant cannot easily do alone.

Recommendation

Keep building. Reply to Koltiva with interest in a small, limited pilot.

- Verdant owns its marketplace, traceability, savings groups (VSLA) and farmer relationships.
- Koltiva is considered as a service partner: field agents, export checks, buyer access.
- Nothing is signed until data ownership, exit and non-exclusivity are written into the agreement.

Decisions needed from Verdant

#	Decision	Our advice
1	Which path: use Koltiva instead of building, build alone, or build and partner?	Build and partner
2	Does Verdant plan to trade cocoa, coffee or other export crops, or sell into the EU, in the next two years?	If yes, Koltiva's export tools become much more valuable
3	Should Verdant reply to Koltiva now?	Yes, open to a scoped pilot conversation
4	Who will review the partnership agreement?	A lawyer, before anything is signed

WHAT KOLTIVA OFFERS

A strong company, built for a different kind of supply chain

Koltiva is a Swiss agritech company working in 94 countries with large buyers such as Mars, Nestlé and Cargill. Its tools mainly help big companies prove where export crops come from.



What is in their offer

- **KoltiTrace:** farmer and farm records, plot mapping, transaction tracking, offline mobile apps.
- **KoltiSkills:** field agents who map farms, survey farmers and run training.
- **Land-use tracker:** satellite checks for forest loss and protected areas.
- **EU deforestation compliance:** risk checks and due-diligence statements.
- **Fintech:** e-wallets, savings, loans and micro-insurance.

How well it fits Verdant

Verdant needs	What Koltiva gives	Fit
Fresh vegetables for Ghana	Built around export crops: cocoa, coffee, palm oil, rubber	Partial
Consumer marketplace and QR story page	No consumer shop or public product story	No
B2B buying for hotels and chefs	Trading tools aimed at commodity buyers	Partial
Farm and plot records	Strong, proven at large scale	Strong
Field team to onboard farmers	Field agents, with an office in Ghana	Strong
Savings groups (VSLA)	Own savings and loans products, which would compete with Verdant's	Overlaps
Export and EU proof	Satellite checks and due-diligence statements	If needed

THE OPTIONS

Three paths open to Verdant

A · Use Koltiva, build no traceability

Not advised

Good

- Fast to start, proven system
- Export and EU tools ready

Risks

- Verdant becomes a customer of a platform, not the owner of one
- Ongoing fees per farmer or per service
- Their app sits between Verdant and its farmers
- The marketplace and QR page must still be built and joined to their system

B · Build alone, decline Koltiva

Possible

Good

- Full control of product, data and farmers
- Platform adds to Verdant's value as a company

Risks

- Slower to onboard many farmers
- No satellite or EU export tools if Verdant needs them later

C · Build own platform, partner for services

Recommended

Good

- Verdant keeps its product, data and farmer relationships
- Borrows Koltiva's field reach, export tools and buyer network
- Can start small and grow only if it works

Risks

- Only safe if the agreement protects Verdant (see page 6)
- Needs someone at Verdant to manage the partnership

How path C works

Verdant platform (main record)

Farms, plots, harvests, handovers, QR pages, marketplace, B2B buying, savings groups

shares only what is needed →

Koltiva services

Field agents, satellite land checks, EU paperwork, buyer introductions

WHERE KOLTIVA CAN HELP

Four areas worth discussing with them

These are things that would take Verdant a long time or a lot of money to build or do itself.

01

Field teams

Their agents could register farmers, walk plot boundaries and run training, using Verdant's own app. Koltiva already has an office in Ghana.

When: now, if Verdant wants to onboard many farmers quickly.

02

Satellite checks and EU paperwork

Their land-use tracker and due-diligence statements took years to build. The EU deforestation rules cover cocoa, coffee, palm oil, rubber, soy, cattle and wood, not fresh vegetables.

When: only if Verdant moves into those crops or EU exports.

03

Access to buyers

Koltiva works with very large food companies. Verdant's traceable produce could reach some of them through Koltiva.

When: once Verdant has steady volumes and quality.

04

Certification and climate data

Support for standards such as GlobalG.A.P. or Rainforest Alliance, and emissions data that large buyers must report.

When: when buyers start asking for certificates.



Good news from their own deck

Koltiva's process takes farm data from other systems by direct connection or spreadsheet upload. This means Verdant can stay the main record and send them only what a service needs. Our design already stores farm maps and records in standard formats so any partner can connect later.

RISKS AND PROTECTIONS

What could go wrong, and how to guard against it

Most risks in a partnership like this come from the agreement, not the technology. Each risk below has a protection Verdant should ask for in writing.

Risk	What it could mean	Protection to ask for
Losing control of farmer data	Farmers become part of Koltiva's network and can be approached for other products.	Data belongs to Verdant and the farmers. Use only for the agreed service.
Being locked in	Hard to leave if prices rise or the service is poor.	Right to export all data at any time, in open formats.
Being blocked from building	An agreement that stops Verdant offering its own traceability, payments or savings tools.	No exclusivity and no non-compete clause.
Competing savings and loans	Their fintech products overlap with Verdant's savings groups (VSLA).	Keep fintech out of the partnership scope.
Unclear costs	Per-farmer fees grow as Verdant grows.	Fixed pilot price, clear pricing for scale.
Two apps for farmers	Farmers get confused using Verdant's app and Koltiva's app.	Field agents use Verdant's app.
Ownership of custom work	Anything built for Verdant ends up owned by Koltiva.	Work paid for by Verdant belongs to Verdant.
Data protection law	Sharing farmer data without consent breaks Ghana's Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843).	Farmer consent, and both parties registered with the Data Protection Commission.

Risk of declining completely

If Verdant later needs export proof or a large field team, building those alone will be slow. Keeping a good relationship with Koltiva now keeps that door open.

NEXT STEPS

Questions to ask Koltiva, and a suggested reply

Questions before deciding

#	Question	Why it matters
1	Can Verdant use only your field services, with its own software?	Shows whether they will act as a partner or only sell their platform
2	How do you charge: per farmer, per year or per service?	Shows the true cost as Verdant grows
3	Who owns the data, and can we take all of it at any time?	Protects against lock-in
4	Can you connect to our system directly?	Keeps Verdant as the main record
5	What have you done with fresh vegetables for local markets?	Tests fit with Verdant's crops

Suggested reply to Koltiva

Dear [Name],

Thank you for your follow-up and for sharing Koltiva's profile. Verdant Foods is building its own digital platform, including traceability, and we would like to explore where Koltiva could support it, especially field services and access to buyers.

We would welcome a meeting to discuss a small pilot with a clear scope. Before then, could you share how you price your services, how data ownership is handled, and whether you can work with data from our own system?

Kind regards,
David
Verdant Foods

Meanwhile

NEXKOOMSON continues building the Verdant platform, including the stronger traceability features, as planned.

Note

This paper is a strategic view, not legal or financial advice. Have a lawyer review any agreement before signing.